

... can trail for millions of kilometres (miles).

Tail light

If a comet's orbit takes it close to the Sun, its surface begins to evaporate, releasing gas and dust. This results in two spectacular tails that point away from the Sun.



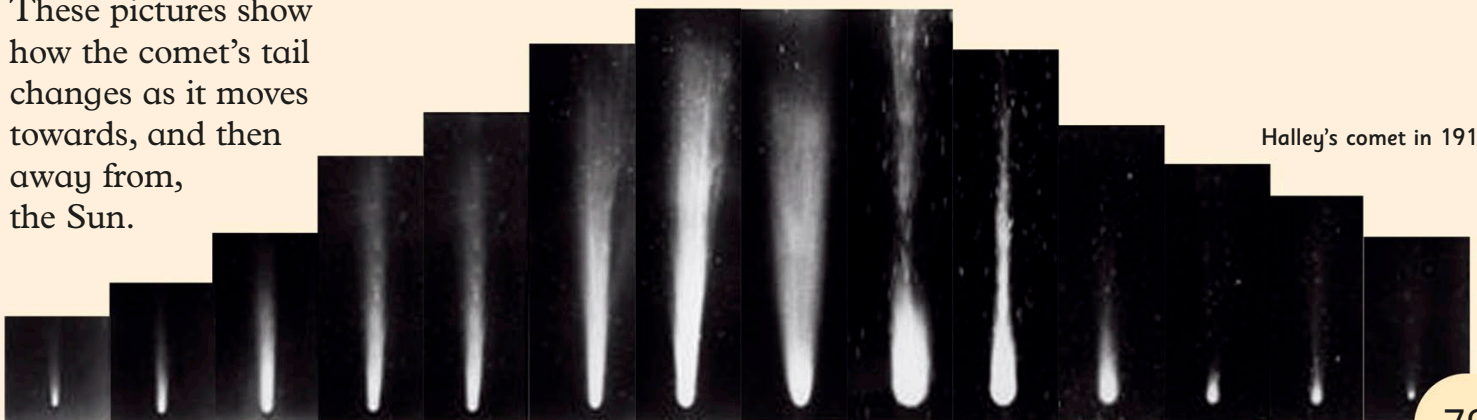
Tail piece

The yellow or white tail is made up of dust. The longer and thinner blue tail is made up of gas. Sometimes the two show up as one tail.



Tail tail

These pictures show how the comet's tail changes as it moves towards, and then away from, the Sun.



Halley's comet in 1910